

July 8, 2022

Matt Gaffney's Weekly Crossword Contest

Back to the Start by Will Pfenhauer and Malaika Handa

<https://xwordcontest.com>

ACROSS

- 1 Grab-and-go breakfast
7 Ambulance abbr.
10 "y'all better start breaking in your ___ martens for the phoebe bridgers concert" (viral tweet)
13 Baseball player Suzuki with 262 hits in 2004
14 ___ 48 (address of "the pit" in "Parks and Recreation")
15 "Abbott Elementary" principal
16 Falsely vouched on one's behalf
18 Boxer with a grill
20 Gridiron increments: Abbr.
21 Telluride, e.g.
23 Water down
24 Hooded cloaks
28 Flute-like instrument played by satyrs
29 The "A" of the ABC islands
31 "A Farewell to Arms" author Hemingway
33 "Yup!"
35 A "hot" one might cause problems
36 Chilaquiles topping, often
40 File type sent by MGWCC
41 Landlocked nation that is only bordered by one country
44 Catan resource
45 Word with "jam" or "brainstorming"
47 Big bird?

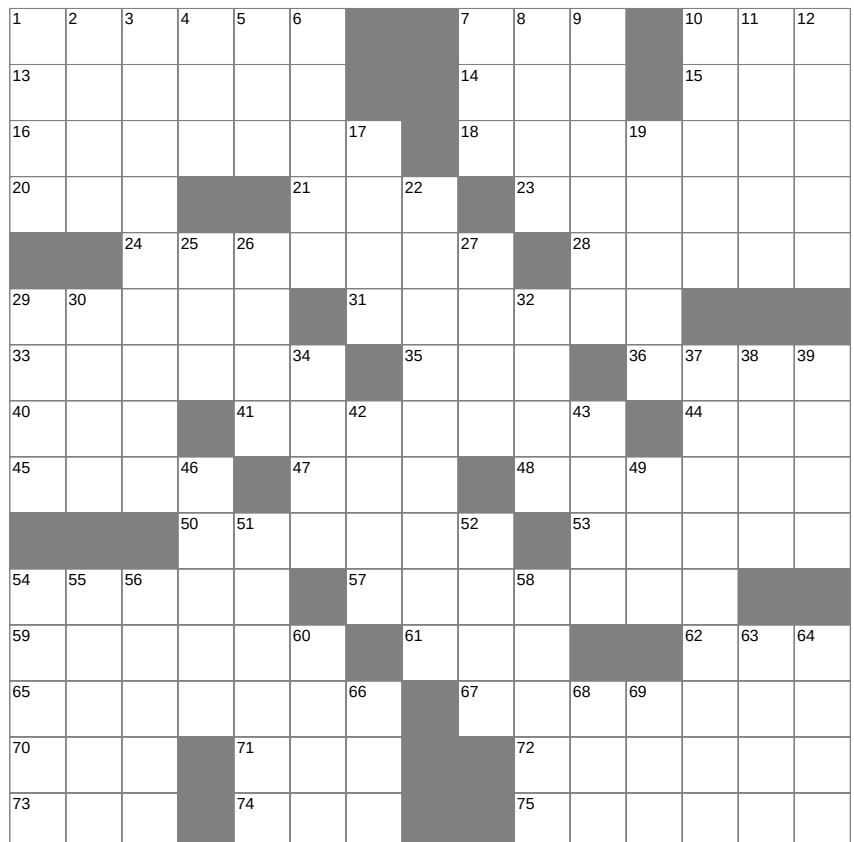
- 48 Buckeye
50 "Drat!"
53 "If It ___ Been for Love" (Adele song)
54 Greek letter used to represent angles
57 Addressing, as many a Shakespeare character
59 Most expansive
61 ID targeted by phishers
62 Like most primes
65 Firmly establish
67 Ben who's the most decorated sailor in Olympic history
70 4G follower
71 Buzzer?
72 Partner in crime?
73 Drug that John Lennon insisted did not inspire "Lucy in the Sky With Diamonds"
74 Words in a Western wedding ceremony
75 Buffy, with respect to vampires

DOWN

- 1 Like one's T-Zone, often
2 "Salt Fat ___ Heat" (Samin Nosrat cookbook)
3 Blue man group?
4 Desire expressed using a paddle
5 Sound from Fido
6 Place for birds to sit
7 Christmas movie in which Will Ferrell is a manic-pixie-dream-boy
8 ___ ring (iridescent accessory)

- 9 Dances like Zola, of "Zola"
10 Completely clog, as a beaver might
11 Shaped like an avocado
12 Props for a classic tap routine
17 Govern, as a queen would
19 The best of the best
22 They can be dry or sweet
25 Name that becomes another name when you move the first letter to the end
26 Get exactly right
27 Apt rhyme for "fit"
29 Creatures said to have spawned from Medusa's blood
30 Word that might be gasped in outrage
32 Annoying sound in a Zoom call
34 "I feel ___" (comment on a particularly relatable meme)
37 "Holy Toledo!"
38 One translation of "abuela"
39 Comforting word to read after finishing an important email
42 Censored stuff
43 "Didn't see you there!"
46 Vibe killer
49 Name that becomes another name when you move the first letter to the end

- 51 Oooh, that's spicy!
52 Cubs player that raced McGwire for a home run record
54 Suit material
55 Three are offered in chess.com's "Friendly" mode
56 Double-___ sword
58 They might be rent-stabilized
60 Fastened, as a rakhi
63 The United States' smallest coin, for some reason
64 Letter opener?
66 Prefix with liberal
68 Org. for Ducks and Penguins
69 Urchin's domain



This week's contest answer is things that often end up where they started.